Introduction to the Philosophy of the Human Person

SYSTEMS PLUS COMPUTER COLLEGE 1985

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Lesson Objectives

- Understand the concept of the human person as an embodied spirit.
- Differentiate between body, soul, and spirit.
- Reflect on the significance of being an embodied spirit in everyday life.
- Apply insights on human embodiment and spirituality to personal growth and relationships.

WELLNESS CHECK

WHAT MAKES US HUMAN?

WHAT is this?



spirit

body

soul



Spirit
(life force)

Body
(physical form)



Soul
(PURPOSE)

What is Spirit?

SPIRIT

The spirit consists of our **mind, will, and emotions**.

It is our personality, thoughts, attitudes and that make us unique.

It is the **immaterial part** of a human being regarded as **immortal**

What is Soul?

Soul

The soul is the real person inside us, it is our **life force**, and it **gives life to the body**.

It has **no feeling and cannot think**.

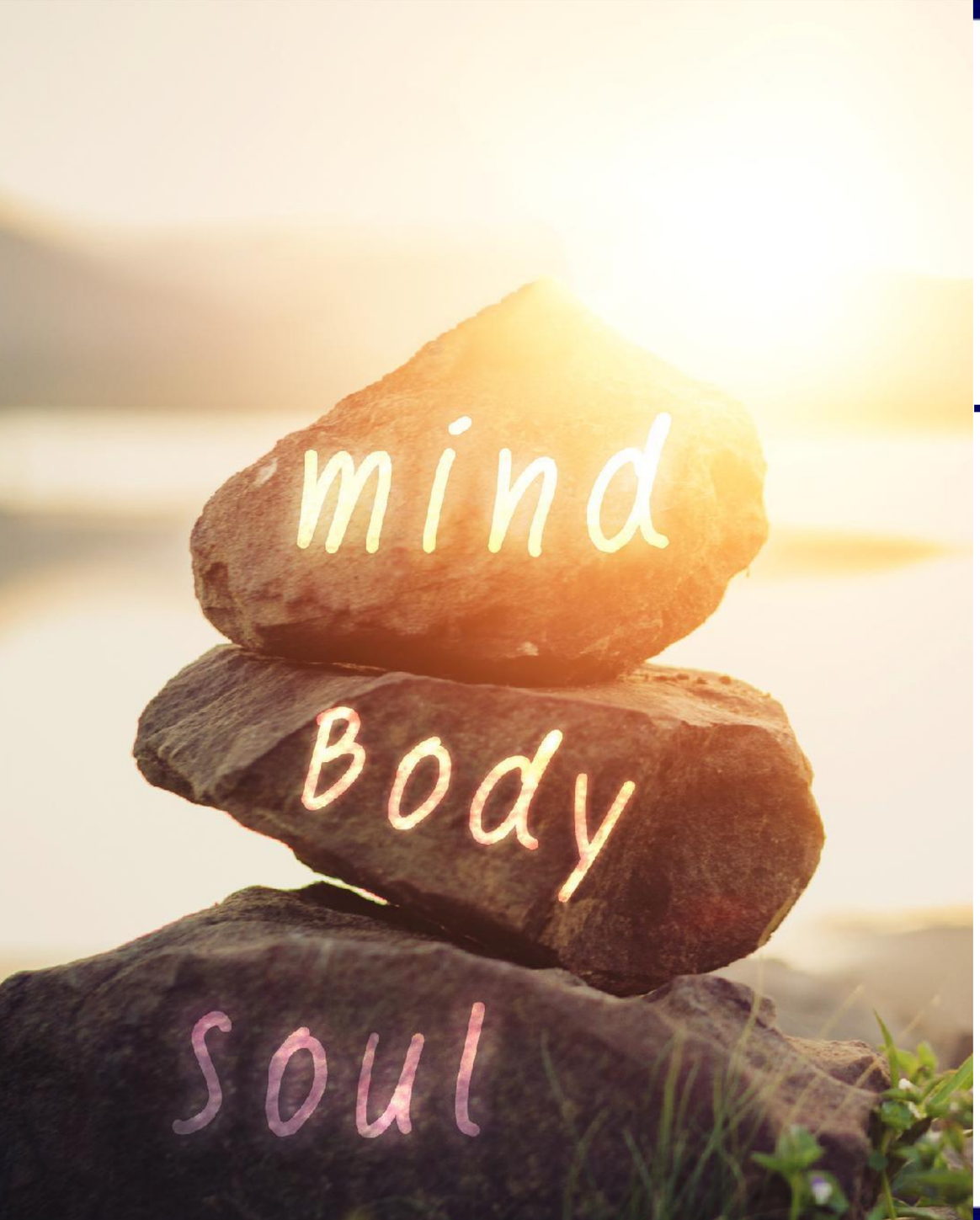
The part of us that **never dies**, that is **eternal**, **infinite**, and **limitless**.

What is Body?

body

It is the **physical structure** of a human, including the flesh, organs, and bones.

This body **has senses** such as seeing, touch, taste, smell and hearing. It can also acquire diseases and disorders.



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THE CONCEPT OF A HUMAN bEING

TWO KINDS OF SPIRIT VIEW

DISEMBODIED

EMBODIED

EMBODIED SPIRIT VIEW

The human person is a unity of both body and spirit.

DISEMBODIED SPIRIT VIEW

The body (physical) is **dependent** on the spirit (non-physical) but the spirit is not dependent on the body.

Plato



- Human is essentially his soul
- The **soul is residing in the world of ideas**
- Body is the prison of the soul
- **Soul is immortal and body is mortal.**

Plato



Tripartite of Soul:

The soul is divided into three parts **(Reasoning, Spiritedness, and Appetites).**

This is based on Plato's The Republic, which decided that the ideal society is made up of **three types of citizens: *workers, soldiers,***

Plato

- The **rulers'** counterpart in the human body is the head, which symbolizes the **reasoning** part.

Plato

- The **soldiers'** counterpart is the chest which symbolizes the **spirited** part.

Plato

- The workers' counterpart is the stomach which symbolizes the appetitive part.

Plato

- **Reasoning > Appetitive** and

  Spirited part
- Plato's idea of good life :

  Life ruled by a reason

rene descartes



- Argued that **we should doubt everything**
- ***"I think therefore I am"***
- "I" = simply a thing that exists
- The **existence of the soul is more distinct** and clear than the existence of the body.

rene descartes

Substance dualism : the mind and the body are two different substances

Different types of substances:

- MIND (non-physical) – it is conscious. It has free will.
- MATTER (physical) – it is not conscious.

Direction:

Read the following questions/statements carefully. Write your answer in a ¼ sheet of paper.

1. What is meant by the term “embodied spirit”?

a) The body and soul are separate entities that never interact.
b) The spirit is imprisoned by the body and cannot be freed.
c) The human person is a union of body and spirit, functioning together as a whole.
d) The body is more important than the spirit.

2. Which philosopher viewed the body as a “prison” for the soul?

a) Aristotle
b) Plato
c) Descartes
d) Thomas Aquinas

3. According to Aristotle, what is the relationship between the body and the soul?

a) The soul is trapped in the body.
b) The soul and body are separate and independent.
c) The soul is the form or essence of the body and they are inseparable.
d) The soul is less important than the body.

4. According to Heiddeger's embodied spirit, a person's spiritual growth can be influenced by their physical experiences.

- True
- False

5. In your own words, explain why it is important to understand the human person as both body and spirit.

“MAN MUST NOT ONLY LIVE

BUT ALSO EXIST”

-Martin Heidegger

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